

STATION 5 : PREPARATION OF THE FOOTBALL EMERGENCY CARE BAG

Instructor Session Flow for Football Emergency Medicine Workshop

1. Introduction

- Welcome participants and outline session objectives.
- Highlight the importance of **pitchside emergency preparedness and quick access to emergency equipment.**
- Briefly explain the different contexts **(single match, tournament, etc.) and number of emergency bags required.**

2. Emergency Bag Setup Overview

- Explain the **recommended number and types of emergency bags per pitch or tournament setting.**
- Emphasize **accessibility of the AED and bags.**

3. Equipment Walkthrough and Demonstration

- Introduce compartments and key equipment categories:
- Airway and Breathing / Oxygen / Circulation/Cardiac
- Trauma/Bleeding
- Musculoskeletal/Sports Injury
- Head Injury/Concussion
- Diagnostics
- Heat/Environmental emergencies (important for local climate)
- PPE/Infection Control
- Medications per- protocol
- Show real equipment or images, highlighting purpose and use.
- Stress function checks (e.g., AED operation, oxygen cylinder pressure).

4. Bag Layout and Organisation

- Demonstrate the 11 compartment layout for ease of use during emergencies.
- Discuss organizing equipment for rapid access and clear labeling.

5. Practical Skill Station

- Scenario briefing: "Prepare and check a fully equipped Football Emergency Care Bag before a match."
- Participants assemble/check their bags under supervision.
- **Provide feedback focusing on preparation, equipment, medication checks, and final safety checks.**

6. Critical Safety Failures Discussion

- Review critical errors to avoid (e.g., no AED, expired medication, inaccessible bag).
- Emphasize importance of emergency access plans and communication with EMS.

7. Q&A and Wrap-up

- Open floor for questions on procedures, equipment, and protocols.
- Summarize key takeaways.

Recommended standard

MATCH SETTING	PRIMARY EMERGENCY BAGS	BACKUP
1 football pitch	1 fully equipped bag	1 reserve/ secondary bag
2 pitches operating simultaneously	2 bags	1 reserve
3 pitches	3 bags	1 reserve
Tournament with multiple simultaneous matches	1 bag per active pitch	At least 1 central reserve
High-risk / large tournament	1 per pitch + dedicated trauma/medical team bag	Additional reserve

Key principle: Do not rely on one bag shared between pitches.

The bag must be immediately accessible at the pitch where the emergency occurs. Emergency planning should be venue-specific and rehearsed before the event.

For a **single football match**, my recommended setup is therefore:

1 × Pitchside Emergency Medical Bag + 1 × backup/resupply bag + 1 × AED
immediately available pitchside.

The AED should **not be buried inside the medical bag**; it needs to be rapidly accessible.

FOOTBALL EMERGENCY CARE BAG — FULL EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST

A. AIRWAY

Equipment	Suggested quantity
Oropharyngeal airway	1 Set
Nasopharyngeal airway	1 Set
LMA/Supraglottic airway/i-gel size 3,4,5	1
Lubricating gel	1
Pocket mask with O ₂ port	1
Magill forceps	1
Portable suction	1
Suction catheters, appropriate sizes	2–3 each
Pen torch	1

B. BREATHING / OXYGEN

Equipment	Suggested quantity
Adult BVM Set	1
Adult face masks	2
Oxygen tubing	2
Non-rebreather oxygen mask	2
Simple oxygen mask	1
Nebuliser mask/set	1–2
Oxygen cylinder	Separate dedicated cylinder
Oxygen regulator	1
Pulse oximeter	1
Spacer device	1

Important: Oxygen availability should be considered part of the pitchside emergency response, not simply an optional accessory.

C. CIRCULATION / CARDIAC

Equipment	Suggested quantity
AED	1
AED adult pads	1 set + spare if available
AED paediatric pads	According to event population
BP machine	1
Adult BP cuffs	1–2
Stethoscope	1
IV cannula 14G	2
IV cannula 16G	2
IV cannula 18G	2
IV cannula 20G	2
IV cannula 22G	2
Tourniquet	2
Alcohol swabs	10
IV dressing/Tegaderm	5
5 mL syringe	5
10 mL syringe	5
Needles	Assorted
IV giving set	2
Normal saline 0.9%	According to clinical protocol
Sharps container	1

Football emergency-care approach specifically identifies rapid recognition, CPR and defibrillation as critical components of field-of-play cardiac emergency management.

DIAGNOSTIC EQUIPMENT

Minimum:

- BP machine
- Stethoscope
- Pulse oximeter
- Glucometer
- Blood glucose strips
- Lancets
- Thermometer
- Pen torch
- Watch/timer
- **ECG machine — preferably with the medical team/medical room rather than inside the bag**

HEAT / ENVIRONMENTAL EMERGENCIES

For football in Malaysia, I would make this a **mandatory module**.

- Instant cold packs
- Ice
- Ice-water immersion capability where appropriate
- Cooling towels
- Spray bottle
- Water
- Oral rehydration solution
- Cooling blanket
- Fan
- Wet towels
- Thermal blanket

The pre-event emergency plan should specifically address exertional heat illness and rapid cooling before transport.

MEDICATIONS — IMPORTANT

EMERGENCY DRUG POUCH

The actual drugs and quantities must follow the **event medical director's standing orders, prescriber authority, Malaysian regulations, formulary and local SOP**. Do not place prescription medicines into a generic football bag without an approved medication protocol.

A typical advanced pitchside medical service may consider having protocols/supply for:

Clinical problem	Medication category
Anaphylaxis	Adrenaline/epinephrine IM
Asthma/bronchospasm	Salbutamol ± ipratropium according to protocol
Hypoglycaemia	Oral glucose
Severe hypoglycaemia/unconscious patient	Parenteral glucose/dextrose according to protocol
Pain	Analgesia according to approved formulary
Allergic reaction	Antihistamine according to protocol
Cardiac arrest	Resuscitation drugs only where advanced medical team/protocol supports them
IV fluid requirement	Isotonic crystalloid according to clinical indication

SUGGESTED BAG LAYOUT FOR YOUR SKILL STATION

I would divide the bag into **11 labelled compartments**:

- 1. AIRWAY**
OPA / NPA / i-gel / lubricant
 - 2. BVM & OXYGEN**
BVM / masks / oxygen masks / nebuliser
 - 3. SUCTION**
Suction device / catheters
 - 4. CIRCULATION**
IV cannulas / syringes / tourniquet / IV set
 - 5. DRUGS**
Approved emergency medications
 - 6. TRAUMA**
Gauze / dressing / haemorrhage control / shears
 - 7. SPLINTS**
Splints / sling / bandages / cervical collar
 - 8. DIAGNOSTICS**
BP / SpO₂ / glucose / thermometer / stethoscope
 - 9. PPE & SHARPS**
Gloves / eye protection / sharps box / waste bags
 - 10. CONCUSSION / DOCUMENTATION**
SCAT6 / CRT / forms / pen
 - 11. HEAT / ENVIRONMENTAL EMERGENCIES**
Cold packs / cooling towels / oral rehydration solution / fan
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CRITICAL FAIL ITEMS

For your competency station, I would consider these **critical safety failures**:

- 1. No AED available**
- 2. No oxygen/BVM**
- 3. No suction when required by the service level**
- 4. Unable to identify emergency access/ambulance plan**
- 5. Expired/unavailable emergency medication**
- 6. Bag not accessible pitchside**
- 7. Unable to activate EMS/ambulance**
- 8. Unsafe medication administration**